

Excuse me, are you

FRIEND



CONVICTION NEVER FELT THIS GOOD.

RAISED

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WRITTEN BY RABBI DUVI FELDMAN

B

By now you must have heard it a hundred times over: if you want to succeed at fundraising, all you need to do is “ask, ask, and ask.” So, why isn’t it working? Because asking takes conviction!

The Rebbe once told a donor at dollars, “A fundraising campaign done with humility will have very little money coming in. You must conduct the fundraiser like a storm.” Too often, we allow fundraising to evoke fear and pessimism, self-doubt and anxiety—all antithetical attributes of conviction that erode your chances of success. The good news is, if you have the conviction to walk up to a random stranger and ask him, “Excuse me sir, are you Jewish?” chances are you have the conviction to be a really good fundraiser.

HOW SO?

Effective outreach and effective fundraising share many of the same core principles.

*They both begin with **prospect-ing**, getting to know who your baal habos is and making initial contact. They both require you to engage the baal habos and slowly **cultivate** the relationship. For the relationship to endure, they both need extensive **follow-up** and long term nurturing.*

Let’s look at it through an exchange shluchim encounter myriads of times:

PROSPECTING: Excuse me sir, are you Jewish? *Why, yes I am.*

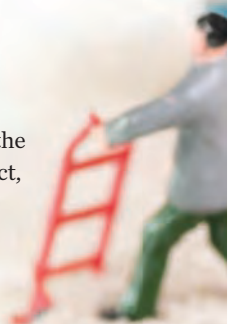
CULTIVATION: Would you like to put on tefilin today? *I suppose I have a few minutes.* **FOLLOW UP:** Can I visit

you next week to put on tefilin once again? *Sure. That would be nice. A perfect encounter in three “asks.”*

But, let’s be honest, if you had lacked the conviction, this encounter would never have taken place. Even with the proper conviction, more times than not the gentleman may refuse.

So, what’s the secret? Why do I have the courage to ask a random stranger to perform a mitzvah even at the risk of being turned down repetitively and embarrassed publicly, yet with fundraising I can’t even bring myself to make the initial ask?

Let’s examine this through the fundraising framework: prospect, cultivate, and follow-up.



PROSPECTING THE FIRST ASK

Fundraising isn't an event, it's a process and that process begins with **prospecting**.

Like in the encounter above, you need to first identify the individual. If he is Jewish you can approach him. If he isn't, you keep moving.

Prospecting is the process of identifying your baal habos. What are his affiliations? What are his interests? What programs does he support? Has he benefited from your organization? These are the details that you need to know before he can even be approached.

Now, think about your organization and the programs you seek to fund. Does this baal habos fit the criteria

of a donor who will fund your specific programs? If no, keep moving.

If the answer is yes, pick up the phone and make the first ask: "Excuse me sir, can we meet for a few minutes? I have a program that may interest you."

The answers will, of course, vary. You'll face rejection on many occasions. At other times, you'll get a nonchalant response: "Sorry, I can't meet with you but I'll give you ten minutes on the phone." Baffled, you may mutter, "With all due respect, I believe that limiting yourself to 10 minutes is an injustice to our institution." But, to no avail, 10 minutes by phone is all he is offering.

And then, in those not-so-frequent instances, you will actually score a meeting.

Have you ever stopped asking strangers if they are Jewish because they told you "no" or even berated you publicly? No, because you are endowed with a

mission from the Rebbe and that mission drives your unwavering conviction.

Now, elevate your fundraising conviction and let's go cultivate a baal habos.

CULTIVATING THE SECOND ASK

With the research performed, preliminaries done, and initial contact made, you are ready to engage.

But note the question we ask in the encounter above, "Would you like to put on tefilin today?"

We don't ask him to come to synagogue, we don't ask him to keep

"Why do I have the courage to ask a random stranger to perform amitzvah even at the risk of being turned down repetitively and embarrassed publicly, yet with fundraising I can't even bring myself to make the initial ask?"



the whole Torah, we don't even ask him to keep half the Torah. We just want a single, solitary unobtrusive action. Because we know that one action leads to another. And this one brief encounter can and will change his life.

Fundraising is no different. At this stage, you introduce yourself and your organization. But, in most instances, it's too early to ask for a donation. Ask for a small action.

Get creative. Ask a different sort of question: "Will you join us for a Shabbos meal?" "Would you like to attend our holiday event?" "Can I ask your advice on a matter you may be familiar with?"

Cultivate your relationship by asking questions that bring you and this donor to shared experiences. Get to know each other. Eventually, you will be able to ask for monetary support for your programs. But, first, it's time to "friendraise." No matter how great an investment your non-profit may seem, major donors still give primarily to organizations they feel an emotional connection with. And that's why cultivating a prospect is a delicate part of the process.

Can you expect to raise money from a person you've just met? Probably not. But once you have "friendraised" and made the second ask, you will find it much easier to go beyond the comfort zone and obtain donor solicitations in the final ask.

Which brings you to the follow-up.



FOLLOW-UP THE THIRD ASK

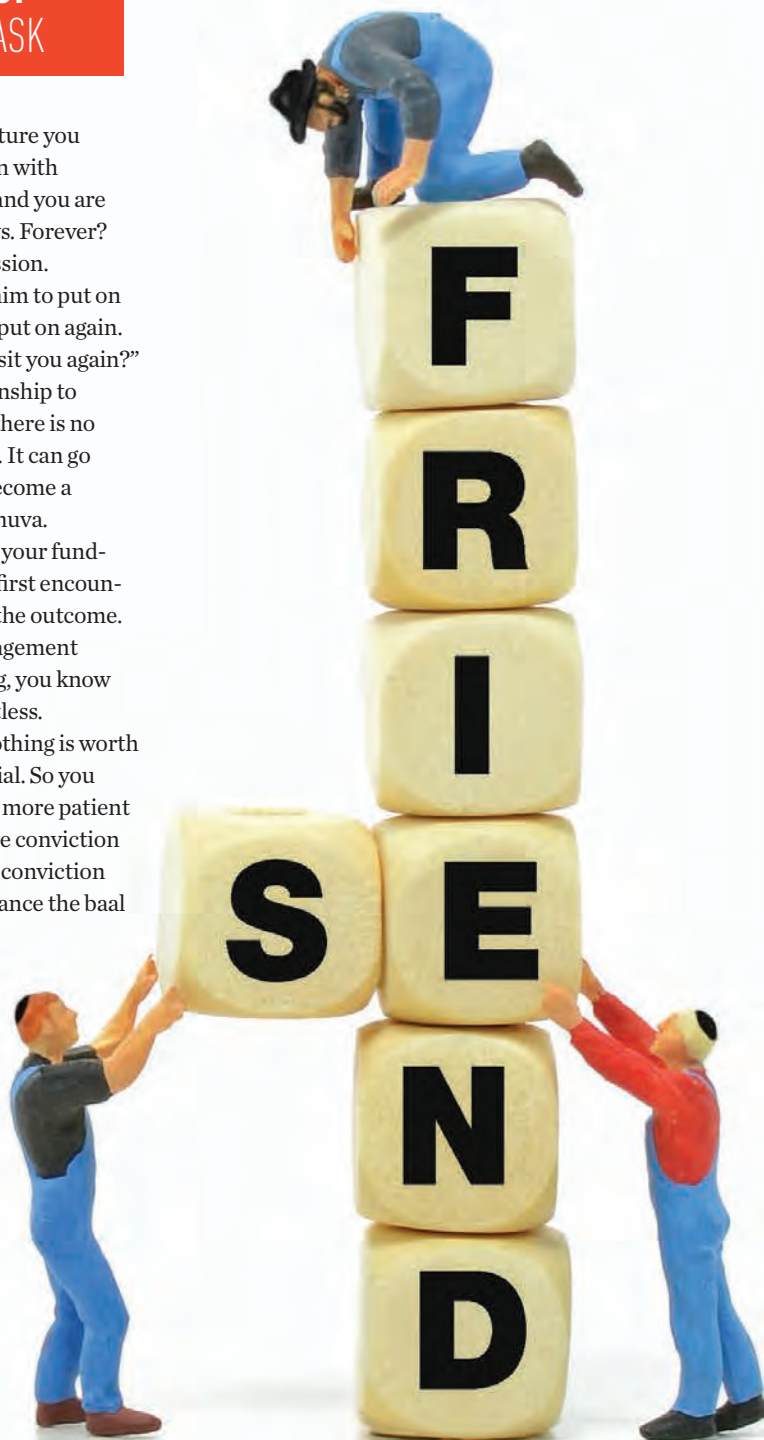
Great! By this juncture you have put on tefilin with your new friend and you are ready to part ways. Forever? Not if you value your mission.

You know if you got him to put on once, you can get him to put on again. So you ask him, "Can I visit you again?"

You want this relationship to continue. And if it does, there is no telling where it may lead. It can go so far as to having him become a fully committed baal teshuva.

So too with regard to your fundraising relationships. In first encounters, you cannot predict the outcome. But, with long-term engagement and relationship building, you know that the potential is limitless.

Most importantly, nothing is worth jeopardizing that potential. So you become patient. And the more patient you become, the more the conviction grows. And the more the conviction grows, the greater the chance the baal



habos will become a partner in your organization. You heard right—partner. The goal of follow-up, or stewardship, is to create partners with a shared interest, not just donors, in your organization.

So, educate your baalei batim. Every industry in the world needs investors and partners in order to thrive and shlichus is no different. The notion that “I have a great relationship with this family but if I’ll ask for money, they’ll run the other way” is a big mistake. Every baal habos can be reached. It’s only a question of mapping out the right plan and following through until you get there. You are the community leader seeking a partner as you work to make a difference in the lives of others. Show the donor the bigger picture. Be transparent. Let him know the mosad’s vision and understand the intricacies of the community.

When the baal habos will feel for your community, he will pick up a percentage of your annual budget. With the dedication and support of this baal habos and your other baalei batim, you can take your community to the next level and overcome every obstacle.

So, if you want to achieve excellence in fundraising, you will need to master the three asks. But, most importantly, you will need to ask with CONVICTION.

The question then becomes, we see how conviction helps during high times, but how does conviction help when the doors keep closing in your face?

The answer, up your game!

WHEN EVERYTHING SEEMS TO BE GOING WRONG

Did you know that in major league baseball, the truly great players successfully hit the ball three out of 10 times while the weak ones only hit it two out of 10. That’s just a 10% difference or one extra hit in 10 tries. Failure remains the largest part of the game...yet players are heralded for their successful contributions.

If in the majors, the difference between failure and

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outstanding success can be one hit, how much more so on shlichus? How often did people lament their failures to the Rebbe, to which the Rebbe responded by completely disregarding the failures and heralding their accomplishments of reaching even one single Jew?

Fundraising is no different. It’s not the misses that add up, but the one extra hit that turns ordinary into extraordinary. And you can bet conviction is the secret to becoming extraordinary.

CONVICTION is in your DNA.

So, go take on friendraising by storm and make today extraordinary!



Many shluchim use Torah Studies for lunch-and-learn sessions, one-on-one learning with baalei batim, and sermon preparation.

OUTREACH AS A MEANS TO INCREASE FUNDRAISING

THIS LETTER WAS ADDRESSED TO R. ARYEH LEIB KRAMER, WHO SERVED AS THE DIRECTOR OF THE LUBAVITCHER YESHIVAH IN MONTREAL.

B"H, 1 Adar I, 5711

Greetings and blessings,

In response to your letter of the 28th of Shvat in which you inform us that you thought of inviting the communal leader R. Moshe Morgenstern as the guest speaker for the annual dinner of the yeshivah and you ask my advice about this. Similarly, you ask for a blessing for success in your efforts.

It is proper for you to invite that communal leader.

May it be G-d's will that you succeed in your efforts both in a material sense and in the spreading of the wellsprings of Chassidus outward.

I have already said several times that, in my opinion, you have restricted yourselves in four limited cubits [of space]. (A double entendre is intended.) When you spread your influence in the city and expand to wider circles of influence – at least slightly in the beginning – expanding the mediums and means of expression employed, additional lights will be drawn down as a result. As these descend lower [until the material plane], this will lead to more money for your appeal. Simply said, you will gather more funds. And this is a mitzvah which another person cannot discharge for you – as it is your duty – or [accrue the] merit [designated] for you.

With blessings and with greetings to the entire fellowship,

Menachem Schneerson



תתקן

ב"ה, א' אדר, ה'תשי"א
ברוקלין

הרח"ח ורח"א אי"א נ"מ עוסק בצ"צ וכו' מוהרא"ל שי

שלום וברכה

במענה על מכתבו מ"ח שבט, המודיע כי עלה בדעתם לכבד את העסקן ר' משה שי מארגנשטערן להזמין בתור אורח מרצה על חמשת השנתי של חשיבה ושואלים עצתי בזה. וכן מבקשים ברכה לחצליח בתעמולתם וכו'.

נכון הדבר שיזמין את העסקן הנ"ל.

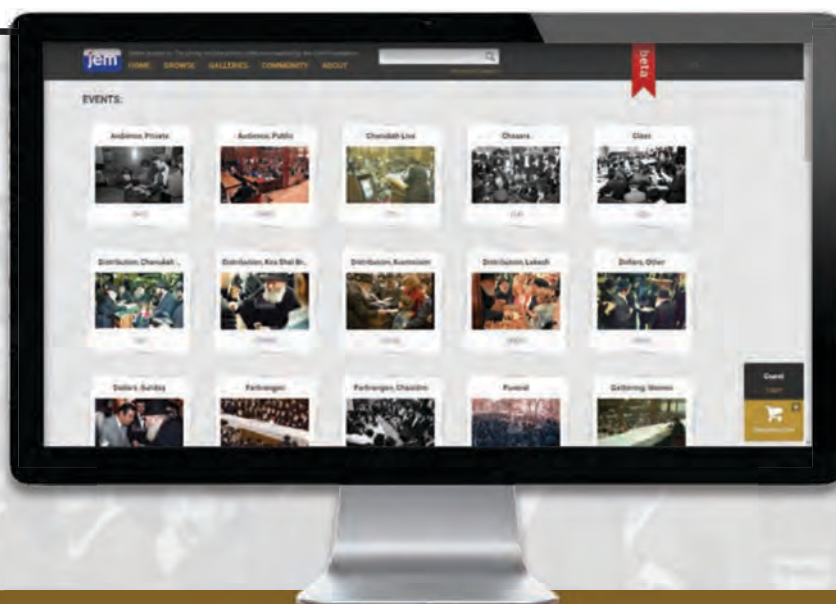
ויהי רצון שיצליחו בתעמולתם הן בגשמיות והן בהפצת מעינות החסידות חוצה.

כבר אמרתי כמה פעמים שלדעתי נצטמצם] ביותר בדי"א עוצבות (תרתי משמע). וכאשר יתפשטו בעיר ויצאו למרחב – עכ"פ במקצת בהתחלה – היא התרחבות הכלים והאיברים, ובמילא ממשיכים תוס' אורות אשר בחשתלשלותם למטה מטה נעשה ג"כ ריבוי במעות המגבית – פשוט מער געלט, והיא מצוה שאין אחר יכול להוציא אותם ידי חובתם וזכותם.

בברכה וד"ש כל החבורה תי.

מנחם שניאורסאהן





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ALTERNATIVE

FUNDRAISING OPPORTUNITIES

“My old routine is not working. What can I do differently?”

Is your fundraising routine running dry? Are you experiencing “fundraising block”? Maybe it’s time to explore new fundraising ideas and opportunities. Many shluchim are finding enormous success in these fundraising areas:

The Shlucha as Friendraiser

Often, female philanthropists are more inclined to give woman-to-woman, giving shluchos reason to consider jumping on the fundraising bandwagon. In fact, some 1-2 dozen shluchos today are the sole fundraisers for their Chabad Houses.

Empowering Friends to be Friendraisers

Your baalei batim generally don’t want to be the ones to do the ask, but, more often than not, they’ll be glad to introduce you to their friends. Tom will have no problem saying, “Harry, you’ve got to have a Shabbat dinner at my rabbi’s house. The food

“Harry, you’ve got to have a Shabbat dinner at my rabbi’s house. The food is out of this world and he and his family make such great company.”

is out of this world and he and his family make such great company." Once the introduction has been made, the path has been cleared for you to build the relationship and do the ask.

Estate Planning

There are people who will not give money now. If you know of people like that, you need to establish a relationship with them and convince them to include you in their wills. This needs to be done with lawyers and proper professionals. Contact Merkos' Chabad Tomorrow (*Ed. see page XX within this issue*), through which you can access resources and direction in navigating this sensitive but essential area in your shlichus.

Parlor Meetings

Though not a one size fits all, parlor meetings are a great way to bring new and old people together and can be a great way to expand your donor base. You can feature "Sushi with the Rabbi," a cash appeal, or a women's event, where women are encouraged to each bring ten friends and ask the rebbetzin whatever they'd like.

Building Funds

Eighty percent of the work must be done before the building fund is launched. You need to have very clear plans, allowing you to walk into a donor and ask him specifically which piece of the campus he would like. Additionally, you need a committee, one that will gather every two weeks and discuss where things are at and what you, as a collective group, are doing about it.

These are fabulous ways to expand your current fundraising initiatives and broaden your fundraising capacity. By diversifying your fundraising strategy, you can begin to experience a more consistent flow of funds which can help stabilize a Chabad House during hard financial times.

The CEO of a leading brand of natural, organic skin care products, Rabbi Mendel Duchman relates to corporate and entrepreneurial business people as well as he understands the struggles and dreams of shlichim and educators. Putting his unparalleled expertise as a financial coach to good use, he is credited with helping hundreds of shlichim succeed financially despite the economic downturn.

"The Shlucha as Friendraiser"

The Charity Divide: Study Shows Women More Generous Givers than Men

According to a recent study by the Women's Philanthropy Institute at the University of Indiana, women are as much as 40% more likely to donate than men. What's more, women at nearly every income level are better givers. Not only do they give more often; they also tend to donate more.¹

¹ Newcomb, Tim. "The Charity Divide: Study Shows Women More Generous Givers than Men." Time. Time Inc., 11 Feb. 2011. Web. 08 Dec. 2014.



Beginning in 5775, JLI Teens now offers 50% more classes, with its new, ongoing weekly program that follows the high school calendar.

FROM THE EXPERTS



The Rebbe sent shluchim to educate their communities, not to be fundraisers. So, educate your community. Teach them that every meal you serve costs you money....



SUPPORT: THROUGH UNDERSTANDING AND APPRECIATION

Contributor: Mr. Mark Wilensky

“I’ve only met with David three times. Isn’t it too soon to do the ask?”

Posed all too frequently by shluchim, this question speaks volumes of shluchim’s hesitation to approach people for money.

We have to change our way of thinking: It’s not how many times you interact with someone that will determine whether he’s ready to provide financial support. It’s about where he stands on the following continuum:

UNDERSTANDING: Does the person know what we are about? If yes... APPRECIATION: Does he appreciate and value what we do? If yes... SUPPORT: He can be asked for support.

A person won’t support the shliach unless he appreciates and values what the shliach is doing. And he won’t appreciate what the shliach is doing if he doesn’t understand it.

THE LITMUS TEST: CAMPUS CHABAD HOUSE

Sarah may have eaten at the Cohens’ Shabbos table every week for an entire semester this year, but if her parents respond “Habad, what’s that? How do you spell it?” when Rabbi Cohen calls, they are clearly not ready to be approached for support. They need to be educated, which can then lead to appreciation

and, only then, support.

Conversely, if Sarah has only come over once or twice, yet the parents greet Rabbi Cohen with “Rabbi, Sarah can’t stop talking about you!” you can be sure they stand much further on the continuum.

The best way to find out where the parents stand is to simply pick up the phone and give them a nachas call. You’ll be able to find out whether Sarah has mentioned you and what the parents think of your relationship with her. *“It was great to have Sarah at our table last Friday night. She interacted so well with our children and also made great points in our discussions—it’s clear that she’s a deep thinker and a caring person!”* The parents may not be religious, nor have visited your website or Chabad House, but will still be happy that Sarah is meeting the right kinds of kids through coming to you and, therefore, be glad to support you.

Mark Wilensky is president of High Mark Systems, a sales management training and consulting firm. He’s been providing clients with cutting-edge business skills since 1986. Mark has been training, coaching and consulting with campus shluchim for the past four years. To learn more about what he does, visit www.markwilensky.com.



People who are able to give don't like to feel that they are the only ones giving. By having a Chai Club you will be able to approach these potential donors and say, "Twenty three people give us money every month. Many of them are of meager means but they do give us \$18 per month."



HOW CAN I FUNDRAISE IF I HAVE NO TRACK RECORD?



Community or campus, small town or substantial city, if you're new on the block and have nothing to show for yourself, don't underestimate the power of conviction. Talk about your vision and talk about your lifelong commitment. Statements like "I'm coming in with tenure," or "I hope that one day one of my children will take over my Chabad House for me" create immeasurable impact.

If you're new, what you have to offer is your commitment to the Jewish community on your campus. Many donors will be drawn to support unshakeable commitment to this cause because they know it's needed, and are impressed by anyone with the courage to speak of it. 



The Rosh Chodesh Society is a tight-knit family of 169 instructors and thousands of students, with 174 chapters worldwide.